



FLEET & SHORE PERSONNEL TRAINING

Junior Officers Adaptation & Refreshment Training

Familiarization, STCW watchkeeping refreshment and structured career development for newly joined and junior watchkeeping officers aboard a Glory Ship Management vessel.

STCW Ch. II & III

SOLAS Ch. V

ISM Code

Company SMS

What We Will Cover

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Joining as a Junior Officer — Familiarization & Induction

What new officers must confirm before an independent watch

02

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Fitness for duty and the principles behind safe watchkeeping

03

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Navigation, lookout and handover routines every OOW applies

04

Engine Room Watchkeeping Procedures

Machinery space watchkeeping, alarms and handover

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Communication with Senior Officers & the Master

Reporting, challenge and response, closed-loop communication

07

Competence Building & Career Development

Building toward your next certificate of competency



SECTION 1

Joining as a Junior Officer — Familiarization & Induction

What every newly joined or promoted junior officer must confirm before taking independent charge of a watch.

01

Familiarization Before Independent Watchkeeping

SOLAS, STCW and the Company's SMS all require a structured handover before a junior officer stands an unsupervised watch.

- SOLAS Chapter V, Regulation 14 and STCW both require new officers to be familiarized with shipboard equipment, procedures and their specific duties before being assigned watchkeeping responsibilities.
- A new joiner shadows the outgoing or a senior officer for an agreed handover period before taking an independent watch, as defined by the Company's SMS.
- Familiarization covers bridge or engine control room equipment, alarm systems, emergency procedures and the ship's standing orders.
- The master or chief engineer confirms in writing that a junior officer is fit to stand an independent watch before removing supervision.
- Familiarization is repeated after a long absence, a change of vessel type, or whenever new equipment or procedures are introduced.



Confirm, Don't Assume

Never assume competence carries over automatically between ships — confirm the ship-specific equipment, layout and procedures before taking sole charge of a watch.

What a New Junior Officer Must Confirm

Items the master, chief officer or chief engineer walks through before independent watchkeeping begins.



Navigation & Communication Equipment

Operation of radar, ECDIS, AIS, GMDSS and VHF, and the location of all backup and emergency equipment.



Standing & Night Orders

The master's or chief engineer's standing orders, night order book, and the ship's specific calling-out criteria.



Emergency Procedures & Muster Duties

Your muster list duty, emergency signals and the location of all life-saving and fire-fighting appliances.



Bridge / Engine Control Room Layout

Alarm panels, control systems and emergency stops specific to this ship's bridge or engine control room.

Standing Your First Independent Watch

Confidence should be built gradually, with the master's or chief engineer's explicit confirmation.



Do

- Ask the outgoing officer to walk through any unresolved issue before accepting the watch
- Call the master or chief engineer whenever a situation falls outside the standing orders
- Use checklists for every routine task until they become second nature
- Confirm your understanding of the passage plan or engine room status before taking over



Don't

- Don't accept a watch handover you do not fully understand
- Don't hesitate to call for help because you are newly qualified
- Don't deviate from the standing orders without express permission
- Don't treat the calling-out criteria as optional — when in doubt, call



SECTION 2

STCW Watchkeeping Standards Refresher

The regulatory principles that govern every watch you keep, on the bridge or in the engine room.

02

STCW and the Principles of Safe Watchkeeping

STCW Code Section A-VIII/2 sets out the general principles observed on every watch.

- The STCW Convention, as amended, sets minimum standards of training, certification and watchkeeping for all seafarers worldwide.
- General principles require that a proper lookout be maintained at all times by sight, hearing and all other available means, appropriate to the conditions.
- Watch arrangements must at all times be adequate to ensure a safe navigational or engineering watch, taking account of prevailing circumstances.
- The officer in charge of a watch may not hand over to a relieving officer if there is reason to believe the latter is not fit to carry out watchkeeping duties effectively.
- STCW rest hour requirements — minimum 10 hours in 24, 77 hours in 7 days — apply equally to watchkeeping officers and are strictly enforced.



Fitness for Duty

An officer who is not rested, fit and alert has no business taking a watch — fatigue is a leading contributing factor in navigational and engine room incidents.

Junior Officer Certification Requirements

STCW sets the minimum certificate of competency required for each watchkeeping role.

Role	STCW Reference	Minimum Requirement
Officer in Charge of a Navigational Watch	STCW Reg. II/1	OOW (Deck) Certificate of Competency
Officer in Charge of an Engineering Watch	STCW Reg. III/1	OOW (Engine) Certificate of Competency
General Watchkeeping Principles	STCW Code A-VIII/2	Applies to all watchkeeping officers
Rest Hours & Fitness for Duty	STCW Reg. VIII/1	Minimum 10 hrs / 24, 77 hrs / 7 days

Three Elements of a Safe Handover

A proper handover is the single most effective safeguard against errors carrying over between watches.

1

Brief — the outgoing officer briefs standing orders, traffic, weather and any unresolved issues

2

Verify — the relieving officer independently verifies position, status and equipment before accepting

3

Confirm — the handover is logged and only confirmed once the relieving officer is satisfied



SECTION 3

Bridge Watchkeeping Procedures

03

Refreshing the core navigational routines every deck OOW is expected to apply, watch after watch.

Routine Navigational Watch Tasks

The recurring duties that make up a deck junior officer's watch.



Position Fixing & Plotting

Regular position fixes by the most appropriate means available, plotted and cross-checked against the passage plan.



Collision Avoidance

Continuous assessment of traffic using radar, AIS and visual lookout, applying the COLREGs at all times.



Bridge Equipment Monitoring

Monitoring ECDIS, radar, engine and steering indicators, and reporting any deviation or fault promptly.



Log Keeping

Accurate, timely entries in the deck log recording position, weather, orders given and any incident.

Keeping the Watch Within the Plan

The approved passage plan is the reference point for every navigational decision on watch.

- Monitor the ship's progress continuously against the approved passage plan, noting and reporting any significant deviation.
- Any departure from the passage plan — for traffic, weather or other reasons — should be reported to the master and recorded.
- Parallel indexing, clearing bearings and no-go areas defined in the plan are actively used, not just referred to on paper.
- Under-keel clearance and squat effects are monitored in shallow or restricted waters, especially at speed.
- The passage plan is a live working document — update it and inform the master when conditions materially change.



Call the Master Early

Standing orders define specific calling-out points — but when genuinely uncertain, call early. No master has ever criticized an officer for calling too soon.

Bridge Resource Management in Practice

Simple habits that keep the bridge team working effectively together.



Do

- Maintain a continuous, undistracted lookout at all times
- Speak up immediately if you doubt a decision or observe something unsafe
- Use standard, unambiguous bridge terminology for all orders and reports
- Keep the bridge free of distractions during critical navigation



Don't

- Don't leave the bridge unattended for any reason without proper relief
- Don't allow phones or non-essential conversation during pilotage or restricted visibility
- Don't assume someone else has seen a hazard — report it
- Don't hesitate to use emergency steering or the engine stop if genuinely required



SECTION 4

Engine Room Watchkeeping Procedures

Refreshing the routines every junior engineer officer applies to keep the machinery space safe and running.

04

Routine Engineering Watch Tasks

The recurring duties that make up a junior engineer's watch.



Machinery Monitoring

Regular rounds and continuous monitoring of the main engine, auxiliaries and alarm systems for abnormal readings.



Fuel & Lubricating Oil Management

Monitoring tank levels, transfers and purifier operation, and reporting any abnormal consumption.



Engine Room Log Keeping

Accurate, timely entries recording parameters, orders received and any unusual event during the watch.



Bridge-Engine Coordination

Responding promptly to telegraph/engine order changes and keeping the bridge informed of any machinery limitation.

Responding to Engine Room Alarms

A calm, structured response to an alarm prevents a minor fault becoming a major failure.

- Investigate every alarm promptly — never silence an alarm without first understanding its cause.
- Follow the ship-specific alarm response procedures and manufacturer guidance for the affected machinery.
- Inform the chief engineer immediately for any alarm indicating a risk to the main engine, steering or essential auxiliaries.
- Record the alarm, the cause found and the action taken in the engine room log, however minor it seemed.
- If in doubt about the safety of continued operation, reduce load, switch to standby equipment, or call the duty engineer without delay.



Never Silence and Forget

Silencing an alarm without resolving its cause is one of the most common precursors to a serious engine room incident — always close the loop.

Unmanned Machinery Space Watch

Many vessels run periodically unmanned machinery spaces (UMS) — the duty engineer's responsibilities shift, not disappear.

24/7

The duty engineer remains on call and reachable at all times during UMS operation

IAS

The Integrated Alarm System continuously monitors machinery and alerts the duty engineer directly

Rounds

Scheduled engine room rounds are still carried out even during unmanned periods



SECTION 5

Company SMS Documentation Essentials

The forms, checklists and records every junior officer is responsible for completing, correctly and on time.

05

The SMS Paper Trail

Accurate documentation is not bureaucracy for its own sake — it is how the Company's SMS actually functions.

- Every checklist, permit and log entry is objective evidence that a procedure was actually followed, not a formality completed afterward.
- Risk assessments and permits to work must be completed and signed before the task begins, not filled in retrospectively.
- Non-conformities, near misses and defects are documented promptly through the SMS reporting system, feeding the Company's continuous improvement cycle.
- During an internal or external audit, including Port State Control, incomplete or inconsistent records are treated as a finding in themselves.
- Falsifying or backdating any SMS record is a serious disciplinary matter and can expose the Company and the individual to legal consequences.



If It Isn't Written Down...

...it did not happen, as far as an auditor or investigator is concerned. Complete records promptly and accurately, every time.

Records a Junior Officer Regularly Completes

These documents form the backbone of the ship's day-to-day SMS compliance.



Deck / Engine Log Books

The primary legal record of the ship's navigation or machinery operation, completed contemporaneously each watch.



Risk Assessments & Permits to Work

Task-specific risk assessments and permits for hot work, enclosed space entry and working aloft.



Checklists

Standardized checklists for arrival/departure, watch handover, drills and routine machinery checks.



Non-Conformity & Near-Miss Reports

Reports raised through the SMS system whenever a hazard, near miss or non-conformity is observed.

Keeping Accurate Records

Good documentation habits protect you, your colleagues and the Company.



Do

- Complete entries as events happen, not from memory hours later
- Ask a senior officer if unsure how a particular form should be completed
- Keep language factual, objective and free of speculation
- Report and record a defect the moment it is found



Don't

- Don't leave any checklist item unanswered or ambiguously marked
- Don't pre-sign or backdate any permit, checklist or log entry
- Don't copy previous entries without verifying they still apply
- Don't assume someone else will complete a record that is your responsibility



SECTION 6

Communication with Senior Officers & the Master

Clear, closed-loop communication is what turns a group of individuals into an effective bridge or engine room team.

06

What and When to Report to the Master or Chief Engineer

Knowing exactly when to call the master or chief engineer is a defining skill of a competent junior officer.

- Standing orders set out specific calling-out criteria — traffic density, visibility, alarms and more — that must never be treated as optional.
- Report early rather than late: a timely call about a developing situation gives the senior officer time to act; a late call may not.
- State clearly what has happened, what action has been taken, and what you need from the senior officer — don't make them guess.
- If the master's or chief engineer's instruction is unclear or appears unsafe, say so — a good challenge protects the whole ship.
- Every call, however minor it may feel, is logged along with the instruction received and the action taken.



When In Doubt, Call

No competent master or chief engineer has ever been unhappy to receive a call that turned out to be unnecessary — the opposite is not true.

Principles of Effective Bridge & Engine Room Communication

Drawn from Bridge Resource Management (BRM) and Engine Resource Management (ERM) principles.



Closed-Loop Communication

Every order is acknowledged, repeated back and confirmed as executed — never assumed to have been heard correctly.



Challenge and Response

Any team member, regardless of rank, is expected to question an instruction or observation that appears unsafe or incorrect.



Standard Terminology

Use of IMO Standard Marine Communication Phrases and agreed ship-specific terms removes ambiguity in critical moments.



Situational Awareness Sharing

Regularly verbalizing your assessment of the situation keeps the whole team's mental picture aligned.

ESCALATION

When and How to Escalate

A simple escalation framework removes hesitation in a developing situation.

Situation	First Action	Escalate To
Uncertain about a navigational or engineering decision	Consult standing orders / checklist	Senior watchkeeping officer
Standing order calling-out point reached	Make the call without delay	Master / Chief Engineer
Immediate danger to ship, crew or environment	Take immediate safe action	Master / Chief Engineer, then DPA
Suspected non-conformity or unsafe practice	Document the observation	Safety Officer / SMS reporting system



SECTION 7

Competence Building & Career Development

Turning time on watch into structured progress toward your next certificate of competency.

07

From Junior Officer to Senior Rank

STCW structures career progression around sea time, training and a higher certificate of competency at each step.

12

Typical minimum months of approved seagoing service required between OOW and Chief Officer / Second Engineer certification

CoC

Certificate of Competency upgrade requires approved sea service, further training and a further examination

CPD

Continuing Professional Development — Company and STCW-recognized courses build toward the next rank

What Counts Toward Advancement

Deliberate habits during your junior officer years compound into a strong record for your next certificate.

- Keep your seagoing service record — discharge book and sea service testimonials — complete, accurate and signed promptly at the end of each contract.
- Use onboard training opportunities — drills, familiarization with new equipment, mentoring from senior officers — as deliberate learning, not routine.
- Track required STCW refresher courses, such as proficiency in survival craft and advanced fire fighting, and their renewal dates well in advance.
- A structured record of watches, tasks and incidents handled builds both your competence and the evidence needed for oral examination.
- Discuss your career development plan with the master or chief engineer periodically — most are glad to mentor a junior officer who shows initiative.



Own Your Development

The Company provides the training framework and opportunities, but building a strong record for your next certificate of competency starts with you.

How the Company Supports Your Growth

Structured programmes the Company makes available to junior officers.



Mentoring by Senior Officers

Structured guidance from the master, chief officer or chief engineer during onboard training and evaluation periods.



Shore-Based Training Courses

STCW-mandated and Company-selected courses scheduled around your leave periods to support certificate renewal and upgrading.



Performance Appraisal

Regular, structured appraisal against Company competency standards, with clear feedback on strengths and development areas.



Career Planning Discussions

Periodic discussions with the Company's crewing department about promotion timelines and vessel-type experience.



COURSE COMPLETE

Every watch you keep safely and every record you complete accurately is a building block toward your next rank.

Company DPA — 24/7 emergency line

Fleet Training & Development Department — mng@gloryship.com.tr

Fleet Safety Department — mng@gloryship.com.tr